

Advanced Placement United States History

Unit 2 Long Essay Question (LEQ)

The long essay question requires students to do the following:

Respond to the prompt with a historically defensible thesis or claim that establishes a line of reasoning.

Describe a broader historical context relevant to the prompt.

Support an argument in response to the prompt using at least two pieces of specific and relevant evidence.

Demonstrate a complex understanding of a historical development related to the prompt through sophisticated argumentation and/or effective use of evidence.

Introductory statement:

After the French and Indian War, Great Britain tightened its control over its North American colonies, and colonists developed new and increasingly organized ways to resist British authority.

Prompt:

Evaluate the extent to which British imperial policies influenced the development of colonial resistance in British North America during the period from 1754 to 1776.

Students might consider the French and Indian War, the Proclamation of 1763, the Stamp Act, the Townshend Acts, the Committees of Correspondence, the Coercive Acts, or the First Continental Congress.

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Introductory statement:

In the early 1700s Great Britain governed its North American colonies loosely, but by the end of the eighteenth century the colonies had won their independence.

Prompt:

Evaluate the extent to which the relationship between Great Britain and its North American colonies changed during the period from 1720 to 1783.

Students might consider salutary neglect, the French and Indian War, the Albany Plan of Union, the Stamp Act and the Declaratory Act, the Second Continental Congress, the Declaration of Independence, or the Treaty of Paris (1783).

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Introductory statement:

Colonists who first protested British taxes as loyal subjects increasingly justified their resistance with ideas about representation and natural rights.

Prompt:

Evaluate the extent to which ideas about rights and representation influenced the movement toward independence in British North America during the period from 1763 to 1776.

Students might consider virtual and actual representation, the Real Whigs, John Locke, the Stamp Act Congress, the Declaration of Rights and Grievances, Common Sense, or the Declaration of Independence.

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Introductory statement:

The Continental Army faced the most powerful military in the world, yet the colonists won their independence with help from abroad.

Prompt:

Evaluate the extent to which foreign assistance influenced the outcome of the American Revolution during the period from 1775 to 1783.

Students might consider the Second Continental Congress, George Washington's strategy, the Battle of Saratoga, the Franco-American Alliance, the war in the South, the Battle of Yorktown, or the Treaty of Paris (1783).

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Introductory statement:

During the eighteenth century, immigration and religious revival changed the makeup and the beliefs of colonial society in British North America.

Prompt:

Evaluate the extent to which immigration and religious revival changed colonial society in British North America during the period from 1720 to 1776.

Students might consider natural increase, enslaved Africans, German and Scots-Irish immigration, Jonathan Edwards, George Whitefield, New Lights and Old Lights, or religious toleration.

Key · Practice prompt 1

Evaluate the extent to which British imperial policies influenced the development of colonial resistance in British North America during the period from 1754 to 1776.

Context to say

1. For decades Britain ruled the colonies through salutary neglect, barely enforcing its trade laws and leaving taxes to the colonial assemblies.
2. The colonial population grew fast, and settlers pushed toward the Ohio Valley, land France also claimed.
3. The First Great Awakening had already taught colonists to question established authority.
4. Still, the colonies stayed divided, and in 1754 every assembly rejected the Albany Plan of Union.

Thesis to say (last sentence of the context paragraph)

British imperial policies influenced the development of colonial resistance to a large extent, because the debt from the French and Indian War ended salutary neglect, new taxes created organized protest, and the punishment of Massachusetts united the colonies.

Body 1 · The war debt ended salutary neglect

- French and Indian War: Britain wins but is deep in debt. **How it connects:** the debt is why Parliament now wants money from the colonies, which ends salutary neglect.
- Proclamation of 1763: no settlement west of the Appalachians. **How it connects:** Britain now limits colonists' land too, so colonists who fought for the West feel cheated.
- Sugar Act and Currency Act: revenue enforced, no colonial paper money. **How it connects:** Britain starts enforcing trade laws it used to ignore, the first sign salutary neglect is over.
Say: Because the war left Britain in debt, Parliament began taxing and limiting the colonies, which first turned colonists against British policy.

Body 2 · New taxes created organized protest

- Stamp Act: Sons of Liberty, boycotts, the Stamp Act Congress. **How it connects:** a direct tax on everyday paper produced the first joint protest by several colonies.
- Declaratory Act: Parliament keeps its claim to tax. **How it connects:** repeal did not settle who could tax the colonies, so the fight over taxes continued.
- Townshend Acts: new boycotts, Daughters of Liberty, John Dickinson's letters. **How it connects:** a new tax produced new boycotts and pulled more colonists, including women, into the protest.
Say: Each tax produced a bigger and more united response, so British policy built the resistance it meant to stop.

Body 3 · Punishing Massachusetts united the colonies

- Committees of Correspondence and the Boston Tea Party. **How it connects:** the colonies now shared news and plans, and the Tea Party is what led Britain to punish Massachusetts.
- Coercive Acts: Boston's port closed, the Massachusetts charter gutted. **How it connects:** other colonies feared the same punishment, so they rallied around Boston instead of leaving it alone.
- First Continental Congress: Declaration of Rights and Grievances, boycott. **How it connects:** the colonies acted together as one body, proof that the punishment united them.
Say: The punishment meant to isolate Boston united the colonies instead, and that unity led to the Continental Congress.

Conclusion to say

British policy after the French and Indian War built, step by step, the united resistance it was meant to stop.

Key · Practice prompt 2

Evaluate the extent to which the relationship between Great Britain and its North American colonies changed during the period from 1720 to 1783.

Context to say

1. After the Glorious Revolution, England ended the Dominion of New England and restored the colonial assemblies.
2. Under mercantilism, the Navigation Acts were meant to make the colonies serve England's economy.
3. Britain and France fought King William's War and Queen Anne's War over North America without settling who would control it.
4. By 1720 the colonists were loyal British subjects who largely ran their own affairs.

Thesis to say (last sentence of the context paragraph)

The relationship between Great Britain and its colonies changed to a great extent from 1720 to 1783, because it moved from loose rule under salutary neglect, to direct taxation and control after the French and Indian War, to a complete break that ended in independence.

Body 1 · Loose rule under salutary neglect

- Salutary neglect: trade laws barely enforced; the Molasses Act went unenforced. **How it connects:** because Britain barely enforced its laws, colonists got used to running their own affairs.
- Colonial assemblies controlled taxes through the power of the purse. **How it connects:** the assemblies, not Britain, controlled colonial money, so self-government became normal.
- Albany Plan of Union (1754): every assembly rejected it. **How it connects:** the colonies were still separate and loyal, which shows how loose the ties were.

Say: Because Britain barely enforced its laws, colonists grew used to governing themselves while staying loyal and divided.

Body 2 · Direct taxation and control after the war

- French and Indian War and the Treaty of Paris (1763): France leaves, Britain is deep in debt. **How it connects:** with France gone and Britain in debt, Britain had both the reason and the freedom to control the colonies directly.
- Stamp Act and Declaratory Act: Parliament claims the power to make laws for the colonies "in all cases whatsoever". **How it connects:** Parliament now claimed full power over the colonies, the opposite of salutary neglect.
- Townshend Acts and Coercive Acts: duties pay royal officials, then Massachusetts is punished. **How it connects:** Britain moved from taxing to punishing, so control was now enforced by force.

Say: The war debt led Britain to tax and control the colonies directly, which turned a loose relationship into a fight over who could govern them.

Body 3 · A complete break

- Lexington and Concord (1775): the fighting begins. **How it connects:** the relationship turned from protest into open war.
- Second Continental Congress: Washington named commander; the king refuses the Olive Branch Petition. **How it connects:** the colonies now acted as their own government, and the king's refusal ended hope of reconciliation.
- Declaration of Independence (1776), then the Treaty of Paris (1783) recognizes independence. **How it connects:** the colonies declared themselves separate, and Britain officially accepted it, ending the colonial relationship.

Say: When the king refused to compromise, the colonists formed their own government and declared independence, and the Treaty of Paris (1783) made the break official.

Conclusion to say

In 1720 the colonies were loyal and loosely ruled; by 1783 they were an independent nation, and the French and Indian War was the turning point.

Key · Practice prompt 3

Evaluate the extent to which ideas about rights and representation influenced the movement toward independence in British North America during the period from 1763 to 1776.

Context to say

1. Britain won the French and Indian War in 1763 but was left deep in debt.
2. For decades the colonial assemblies had controlled their own taxes under salutary neglect.
3. The First Great Awakening had already taught colonists to question established authority.
4. After 1763 London meant to manage the colonies directly, starting with the Proclamation of 1763.

Thesis to say (last sentence of the context paragraph)

Ideas about rights and representation influenced the movement toward independence to a large extent, because the belief in actual representation turned taxes into a matter of principle, the Real Whig fear of power made each new act look like a plot against liberty, and natural rights gave colonists a reason to break with the king.

Body 1 · Actual representation made taxes a matter of principle

- Virtual representation (Britain) vs. actual representation (colonists): only elected representatives could tax. **How it connects:** colonists argued Parliament had no right to tax them at all, so the fight became about rights, not money.
- Stamp Act Congress (1765): trade regulation accepted, taxes for revenue rejected. **How it connects:** the colonies drew a line on principle, accepting Britain's control of trade but rejecting its taxes.
- Declaration of Rights and Grievances (1774): the same line between regulation and taxation. **How it connects:** almost ten years later the same principle still drove the protest, which shows the idea held the movement together.

Say: Because colonists believed only their own elected representatives could tax them, they treated the Stamp Act as a violation of their rights, which turned protest into a matter of principle.

Body 2 · Fear of power made each act look like a plot

- Real Whigs: English writers who warned that concentrated power threatens liberty. **How it connects:** their warnings taught colonists to read every new British law as a step toward tyranny.
- Townshend Acts: duties paid royal officials, threatening the assemblies' power of the purse. **How it connects:** colonists saw this as Britain cutting the assemblies out of power, proof of the plot.
- Coercive Acts (1774): the Massachusetts charter gutted. **How it connects:** taking away a colony's own government looked like the plot coming true.
- Committees of Correspondence: spread the warnings from colony to colony. **How it connects:** they spread the fear of a plot from colony to colony, turning one idea into a shared belief.

Say: Because the Real Whigs taught colonists to fear power, each new act looked like part of a plan to take away their liberty, which made compromise harder.

Body 3 · Natural rights justified the break

- John Locke: natural rights and government by consent. **How it connects:** his ideas gave colonists the right to replace a government that took away their rights.
- Common Sense (1776): Thomas Paine's plain case against the king and for independence. **How it connects:** it convinced ordinary colonists to blame the king and want independence, not just their rights back.
- Declaration of Independence (1776): consent of the governed, the right to alter or abolish, grievances against the king. **How it connects:** it used Locke's ideas to justify the break, so the ideas became the official reason for independence.

Say: Common Sense and the Declaration moved the argument from rights as Englishmen to natural rights, which gave colonists a reason to break with the king.

Conclusion to say

Ideas about representation turned taxes into a fight over rights, and ideas about natural rights turned that fight into independence.

Key · Practice prompt 4

Evaluate the extent to which foreign assistance influenced the outcome of the American Revolution during the period from 1775 to 1783.

Context to say

1. The French and Indian War gave colonists, including a young George Washington, military experience.
2. Britain's war debt led to taxes that colonists resisted from 1765 on.
3. The Coercive Acts (1774) led to the First Continental Congress.
4. Fighting began at Lexington and Concord in 1775, against Britain's professional army and the world's strongest navy.

Thesis to say (last sentence of the context paragraph)

Foreign assistance influenced the outcome of the American Revolution to a large extent, because the victory at Saratoga brought France into the war, French troops, money and supplies strengthened the Continental Army, and the French navy made the decisive victory at Yorktown possible.

Body 1 · Saratoga brought France into the war

- Saratoga (1777): a whole British army surrenders. **How it connects:** a major American victory showed France the war could be won.
- The victory proves the Americans can win. **How it connects:** France did not want to back a losing side, so proof the Americans could win mattered.
- France wants revenge for losing the French and Indian War. **How it connects:** France already wanted to weaken Britain, so Saratoga gave it the chance.
- Franco-American Alliance (1778). **How it connects:** the alliance is what brought French troops, money and ships into the war.

Say: The victory at Saratoga proved the Americans could win, which convinced France to ally with them and turned a colonial rebellion into a war against a world power.

Body 2 · French help strengthened the Continental Army

- French troops and military advisors. **How it connects:** they added to and trained an army that was smaller and less experienced than Britain's.
- Money, supplies and gunpowder. **How it connects:** the colonies could not produce enough on their own, so French supplies kept the army fighting.
- Britain now fights France around the world and moves the war to the South. **How it connects:** Britain had to spread its forces around the world, so it could not put everything into the colonies.

Say: French troops, money and supplies kept the Continental Army fighting, and fighting a world power forced Britain to spread out its forces.

Body 3 · The French navy made Yorktown possible

- Yorktown (1781): the French navy blocks a British escape by sea. **How it connects:** the British army could not be rescued or resupplied by sea, so it was trapped.
- French and American troops trap the British army on land. **How it connects:** with the sea closed off, the combined army forced the surrender.
- Britain stops offensive operations; the Treaty of Paris (1783) recognizes independence. **How it connects:** losing a whole army ended Britain's will to keep fighting, so the war ended in independence.

Say: Because the French navy cut off the British army at Yorktown, Britain lost the decisive battle, which led it to end the war and recognize independence.

Conclusion to say

Saratoga brought the French alliance, and the French navy made Yorktown possible, so foreign help decided how the war ended.

Key · Practice prompt 5

Evaluate the extent to which immigration and religious revival changed colonial society in British North America during the period from 1720 to 1776.

Context to say

1. By 1700 the colonies were mostly English settlements along the coast.
2. The Chesapeake and South Carolina had become slave societies, while New England remained a society with slaves.
3. Established churches, Puritan in New England and Anglican in the South, shaped colonial life.
4. After the Glorious Revolution the colonists saw themselves as loyal Protestant British subjects.

Thesis to say (last sentence of the context paragraph)

Immigration and religious revival changed colonial society to a large extent, because enslaved Africans and European immigrants made the colonies far more diverse, new settlers pushed settlement west into the backcountry, and the First Great Awakening split the churches and taught colonists to question authority.

Body 1 · A more diverse population

- Enslaved Africans: the largest group of newcomers, forced migrants. **How it connects:** forced migration made Africans a large part of the population, especially in the South, changing who lived in the colonies.
- Germans, most after 1730, many to Pennsylvania. **How it connects:** they brought their own language and churches, so the colonies became less English.
- Scots-Irish, most after 1730. **How it connects:** another large non-English group, adding to the colonies' diversity.
Say: Forced and free migration made the colonies far less English and more diverse, and slavery grew alongside the free population.

Body 2 · Settlement moved west

- Germans and Scots-Irish settle the backcountry, from Pennsylvania south. **How it connects:** newcomers moved past the older coastal settlements, spreading colonial society west.
- Natural increase adds to the push for land. **How it connects:** a growing population needed more land, adding to the push west.
- Settlers press toward the Ohio Valley, land France and Native nations also claimed. **How it connects:** the push west led to conflict with France and Native nations, which led to the French and Indian War.
Say: Because new settlers moved into the backcountry, colonial society spread west, which set up the land conflicts behind the French and Indian War and the Proclamation of 1763.

Body 3 · The First Great Awakening

- Jonathan Edwards: "Sinners in the Hands of an Angry God". **How it connects:** his preaching brought emotional, personal religion to ordinary colonists.
- George Whitefield: an itinerant preacher who drew huge crowds. **How it connects:** he preached outdoors across the colonies, so the revival reached people outside the established churches.
- New Lights vs. Old Lights: congregations split, denominations multiplied, toleration grew. **How it connects:** the splits created new churches and more toleration, teaching colonists they could challenge established authority.
Say: The revival split the churches and multiplied denominations, which taught ordinary colonists they could challenge established authority.

Conclusion to say

By 1776 the colonies were more diverse, spread farther west, and more willing to question authority than they had been in 1720.